

Standoff in San Diego over ICE

County leaders vote to restrict cooperation with immigration officials; sheriff balks.

By Salvador Hernandez

A new immigration policy adopted by the San Diego County Board of Supervisors was supposed to stop jails from working with federal immigration officials, a move that would potentially hinder President-elect Donald Trump's promise of mass deportations.

But the county is now locked in a standoff in what could be a preview of local immigration politics after Trump retakes office in January.

San Diego County Sheriff Kelly Martinez said her office won't comply with the county's policy and would continue to notify U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement officials when some people not authorized to be in the country are released from county jails.

"The Sheriff, as an independently elected official, sets the policy for the Sheriff's Office," the office said in a statement hours after the board approved the policy. "The Sheriff has the sole and exclusive authority to operate county jails."

The stalemate comes as some California jurisdictions are bracing for Trump's promise on deportations and adopting policies designed to protect immigrant communities. Some California officials, including Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta, said they are readying for legal fights against the incoming administration.

The clash between the majority of San Diego County's Board of Supervisors and its sheriff also illustrates how — even in California, a sanctuary state — efforts to undermine the Trump administration's deportation plans could face legal challenges, practical hurdles and clashes when local officials disagree.

[See Immigration, A9]

Man is guilty of killing tech exec

An acquaintance is convicted of murdering Cash App founder Bob Lee in San Francisco. CALIFORNIA, B1

Diversity on TV still a challenge

Women play a key role in UCLA's reformatting Hollywood Diversity Report. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

Bay Area is a salary standout

California region leads the nation in jobs that pay at least \$500,000, ADP report says. BUSINESS, A8

Weather
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Photographs by NOAH HAGGERTY Los Angeles Times

MEGAN FISKE and other forest advocates fear that the California biofuel project would open the door to clear-cut logging.

Biofuel plans alarm a community

STOCKTON — For Laura Ornelas and thousands of other South Stockton residents, harmful air pollution is a fact of life.

Hemmed in by freeways and rail lines and bordered by heavy industry and the Port of Stockton, the area has been dubbed an "Asthma Capital" by the Asthma and Allergy Foundation of America.

Ornelas, who rents a house in the Boggs Tract neighborhood, says she has to wear a mask just to work outside, or to clean the soot off her car every few days. She said her 91-year-old mother's mysterious cough worsened after they moved in at the start of the year.

"We just need to get out of here," she said.

For Ornelas and her neighbors, local air pollution could get even worse if officials approve plans for a massive forest management and biofuel project that would harvest trees across California through wild-

A project to reduce wildfire risk could worsen air pollution in South Stockton

By Noah Haggerty



LOGS ARE transported to a Tuolumne County property where the state hopes to build a wood pellet processing plant.

fire mitigation work, process them into wood pellets at facilities in Lassen and Tuolumne counties and ship them off to Europe and Asia to burn for electricity.

All of the wood — more than 1 million tons every year — would converge at storage facilities at the Port of Stockton.

The proposal has alarmed local groups that say the community has suffered poor health and government neglect for far too long. They question whether the proposal will actually reduce the threat of wildfire, and wonder why South Stockton should shoulder the burden of increased truck and shipping pollution.

Environmental advocates also worry that the forest thinning portion of the project will focus more on biofuel companies' bottom lines than forest health, doing little to prevent wildfires.

The enormous project has [See Biofuel, A6]

Trump suit targets top Iowa pollster and newspaper

Claim that they tried to boost Harris could chill assessments of elections, experts fear.

By James Rainey

In his latest step to strike back against media outlets he says have said wronged him, President-elect Donald Trump has filed a lawsuit against an Iowa pollster and newspaper that he said intentionally skewed a poll against him to try to help Vice President Kamala Harris in the November election.

A legal expert gave the litigation little chance of succeeding, and press freedom advocates protested it as another retaliatory measure designed to chill news agencies from making fair assessments of the incoming president — particularly after other Trump lawsuits against media institutions including CBS News, ABC News and the board that oversees the Pulitzer Prizes.

ABC News agreed last week to pay \$15 million

toward Trump's presidential library to settle a lawsuit over anchor George Stephanopoulos' inaccurate on-air assertion that the president-elect had been found civilly liable for raping writer E. Jean Carroll.

Some of Trump's supporters cheered the Iowa lawsuit and supported its contention that pollster J. Ann Selzer and the Des Moines Register intended to influence the election outcome, though they presented no evidence of malfeasance or collusion intended to favor the Democratic presidential candidate.

Trump's lawyers filed the action Monday in a state court in Polk County, home to the state capital of Des Moines and the Register, Iowa's leading newspaper. The president-elect had signaled the action in a news conference earlier in the day, saying: "In my opinion, it was fraud and it was election interference."

"Defendants and their cohorts in the Democrat Party hoped that the Harris Poll would create a false nar-

[See Trump, A7]



Associated Press

THE BLAST that killed Russian Lt. Gen. Igor Kirillov was attributed to Ukraine. Analysts say both sides seek to inflict blows to gain leverage in any future talks.

ANALYSIS

Assassination may portend new phase in Ukraine war

By Laura King

WASHINGTON — On the snowy sidewalk of a drab residential street in Moscow, blood, soot and the mangled remnants of an electric scooter marked the spot where a top Russian general was assassinated — and signaled a potentially danger-

ous new phase of the war in Ukraine.

Coming just over a month before President-elect Donald Trump takes office, the bombing that killed Lt. Gen. Igor Kirillov and his assistant on Tuesday was widely attributed to Ukraine, which stopped short of a formal claim of responsibility but quietly let

the role of its security services be known.

Kirillov, 54, was the highest-ranking Russian military figure to die outside the battlefield since the start of Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine nearly three years ago. With the U.S. president-elect vowing to bring a swift end to the fighting, analysts [See Analysis, A4]



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